THE PLUG



THE PLUG
Expansion Plan

The DA HOOD partnership, an open marketplace anyone can sell on, events and tickets, Freetown-first delivery, and a map built for how Freetown really gives directions.

Ideas from 14 October 2026 Freetown, Sierra Leone Working draft

AT A GLANCE

Five big moves, in the order we'd build them

This plan collects everything we talked through after the first prototype: how THE PLUG and DA HOOD can work together, turning THE PLUG into a marketplace where any business or person can sell, an events calendar with our own tickets, how far we deliver, and the Freetown map. The updated prototype that comes with this PDF shows most of it working with sample data.

1
Open marketplace
Any business, brand or person lists what they sell. Customers compare sellers on price, stock and distance.

2
Business pages
Every seller gets a "by ..." tag that opens their own page, which grows into a full mini-website inside THE PLUG.

3
Events and tickets
No ads needed. One calendar for everything on in Freetown, tickets sold by us, checked at the door by our agents.

4
Freetown first
Fresh and hot goods stay in Freetown. Long-lasting goods can travel to Bo, Makeni and Bonthe by parcel.

5
Our own map
Landmarks and pins now, 360° street photos next, 3D for key areas later.

+
DA HOOD
Partner on events, merch, transport, G.W.E.N and jobs, through small written deals.

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Honest status. Everything here is a plan. No partner agreements are signed, no payments are connected, and every seller, price, event and stock number in the prototype is sample content.

SECTION 1

Partnership with DA HOOD

THE PLUG and DA HOOD fit together best through a few small, written deals, not a merger. Each deal can be tested on its own and stopped without hurting the other side.

Where they connect

AREA	HOW IT WORKS	THE PLUG SERVICES USED
Events Car Theaters, festivals, esports nights	Food vendors take pre-orders and a rider brings food to the car or seat. Rides and party buses take people to and from the event. Tickets sold through THE PLUG.	Eats, One Delivery, Ride, Events and tickets
Clothing and merch	DA HOOD clothing sells as a store with its own business page. Studio prints the T-shirts, mugs and banners. Members who shoot photos can be Studio photographers.	Open marketplace, business page, Studio
Transport	The e-kekes and buses become ride supply on THE PLUG. The 50% student price becomes a student rate in the app. This deal is with the personal transport business, not the DA HOOD group.	Ride, Travel transfers
G.W.E.N	The keke and truck collection runs use THE PLUG dispatch, so they get routes and tracking without building their own system.	Dispatch, Errands
Jobs for members	Members can work as couriers, Errand Runner runners and event door agents for student income. Marketing, web and security-minded members can be Studio providers.	Couriers, runners, agents, Studio

How to structure it

- **One short agreement per project:** who does what, the commission or revenue split, and how long it runs. "Events delivery" is one agreement, "merch on the marketplace" is another.
- **Keep the NGO separate:** the Da Hood Collective and G.W.E.N never mix funds with THE PLUG. They connect only through paid service deals that are written down.
- **Write down who signs:** THE PLUG is owned by you and your friend, and the DA HOOD trust and group company are still forming. Name who signs for each side.
- **Trademark first:** register the DA HOOD name before it appears inside a third-party app.

> **First pilot:** one DA HOOD Car Theater night run through THE PLUG. Food pre-orders delivered to cars test One Delivery for real, tickets test the door agents, and it markets both brands for almost no cost.

SECTION 2

Open marketplace: anyone can sell

Any registered business, brand or person can put what they sell on THE PLUG, from a supermarket to someone selling fruit from home. Customers search once and see every seller.

One product, many sellers

When 15 people sell Maggi cubes, the app keeps **one shared product** and each seller attaches an **offer**: their price, stock left and location. The customer sees all offers side by side and sorts by cheapest, closest or most in stock. This avoids 15 duplicate listings and makes comparing honest.

Customer searches "Maggi cubes" → **One product page** all sellers listed → **Compare** price, stock, distance, "by" tag → **Basket** mix sellers freely → **One Delivery** combined when it saves

- **Stock that stays true:** sellers update stock with one tap (+/–, or "sold out"). If a seller hasn't confirmed stock in a few days, the offer shows "stock not confirmed" and the customer asks first, the same rule as unconfirmed restaurants.
- **Fruits and vegetables:** listed per kg, bunch or heap, with the seller's own photo, since every tomato heap is different.
- **Ordering is reserved:** placing an order holds the stock so two people can't buy the last one.

Listing in under a minute

1. **Snap a photo.** The background is removed automatically and the product sits on a clean white or transparent background. The seller sees before and after and can keep the original.
2. **Match or create.** If the product already exists ("Maggi cubes, 100 pack"), the seller just picks it. If not, they type a name and category.
3. **Price and stock.** Two numbers, and whether it lasts (can travel outside Freetown) or spoils (Freetown only).
4. **Live.** It appears in search under the seller's "by" tag straight away, or after a quick check for new sellers.

> **Background removal is real but not magic.** Plain backgrounds work very well. Hair, glass and fruit piles sometimes come out rough, and each photo costs a little to process. That is why the seller always sees the result and can keep the original. The prototype includes a simple working version for plain backgrounds.

Search by photo. A customer who doesn't know a product's name takes a picture and the app shows similar listings. It works well for packaged goods with clear labels and less well for loose produce. It also needs a big catalogue first, so it comes in phase 2. The prototype shows the screen and labels it as not connected yet.

SECTION 3

Business pages and "by" tags

Every product shows a small tag like "by Owen" or "by JSK". The seller chooses what it says. Tapping it opens that seller's own page, which looks like their own website, inside THE PLUG.

How the tag works

- The tag is a **clickable badge** on the product, not burned into the photo, so the seller can change it any time and the photo stays clean.
- It can be a business name, a brand or a person's name.
- **No impersonation:** nobody can tag themselves as another brand ("by Maggi official"). Real brands and verified businesses get a verified badge.

Page levels

LEVEL	WHO GETS IT	WHAT IT INCLUDES
Simple page	Sellers with 1–4 products	Made automatically from their name, logo or initials and a colour. Shows their products, area and "by" tag. Still clearly theirs, just not customisable yet.
Custom page	Sellers with 5 or more products (suggested, adjustable)	Their own colours, logo, banner, layout, about section, opening hours, featured products and a link to their own website. Set up during sign-up so it feels like their own app.
Service page	Any service provider from day one	Nail techs, lash techs, barbers, photographers: a menu of services with price and time, a gallery, location and booking requests. Services work like a menu, so they don't need a product count.

Upgrade path. When a simple-page seller adds their fifth product, the app tells them "Your custom page is unlocked" and opens the page designer. Nothing they already listed is lost.

Already have a website?

Their page shows a "Visit our website" button. THE PLUG page handles orders and delivery; their own site can hold everything else.

What makes it feel like their own app

Theme colour, logo, banner, the order of sections, featured products, and their own words in the about section. The checkout and delivery stay THE PLUG's, so customers get the same protection everywhere.

SECTION 4

Service providers and quote requests

When a customer needs something done, like printing, and our own print shop is busy or doesn't offer it, other registered providers see the request and decide whether to take it.

Customer posts
what, how many, deadline, area, file

→

Matching providers
in that category and area are notified

→

Providers reply
accept with a price and time, counter, or decline

→

Customer chooses
best price, fastest, or nearest

→

Booked
tracked like any other order

- **Fixed prices too.** Providers can list set prices (100 business cards, NLe X), so simple jobs are ordered instantly without waiting for quotes.
- **Our Studio is one provider among many.** It competes fairly in the list.
- **Response window.** Requests close after a set time (suggested 30 minutes for urgent jobs, a day for big ones), so nobody waits forever.
- **No spam.** Requests only go to providers in the right category and area. Customers can't see a provider's phone number until they book.

SECTION 5

Rules that keep it safe

An open marketplace only works if customers trust it. These rules go in before launch.

Banned and restricted goods

- Medicines only through licensed pharmacies in Care, never on the open marketplace.
- No counterfeit, illegal or dangerous goods.
- Age-restricted goods only from verified sellers, with ID at the door.

Sellers who work from home

Their pickup address is shown only to the assigned rider, never to customers. Customers see the area only.

Trust

- Light verification: phone for everyone, ID and business papers for businesses.
- Reviews only after a real, delivered order.
- Report buttons and a dispute process with a real person.

Money

- A commission per sale (rate still to decide).
- Payouts to sellers on a fixed schedule.
- Refund rules shown before checkout.

SECTION 6

Events, tickets and door agents

No ads. Every event in Freetown goes into one calendar, so anyone who opens it sees what's on. We sell the tickets ourselves and our agents check them at the door.

The calendar

- Organizers post an event: date, time, place, flyer, ticket types and refund rules.
- Customers filter by day, area or type: music, comedy, sports, car cinema, festivals, esports.
- **THE PLUG picks:** our own enjoyment timetable of shows, chosen by a person on our team, marked so people know it's a pick.
- **Checked organizers:** new organizers are reviewed before they can sell tickets. Free events can be listed while review happens, marked "pending review".

Tickets

SAMPLE TICKET

DA HOOD Car Theater: Friday Night

Car pass · admits one car

Backup code **PLG-7K3Q**



One scan only

- Bought in the app, delivered as a QR code plus a short backup code for dead phones.
- Each ticket works **once**. A screenshot shared with a friend only gets the first person in.
- A small ticket fee is THE PLUG's income. Who pays it (buyer or organizer) is still to decide. The full price is always shown before paying.
- **Payouts after the event.** If the event is cancelled, buyers are refunded from money we still hold.

Door agents

Scanner screen

Green for valid, red for used or fake, and the ticket type (regular, VIP, car pass).

Works offline

Signal at venues is unreliable, so the agent's phone downloads the ticket list before doors open and syncs afterward.

Accountable

Agents sign in with their own account, so every scan shows who checked it. Cash sales at the door are recorded too.

Payment dependency. Online ticket sales need a payment provider (mobile money first). Until one is connected, the prototype uses demo payments only.

SECTION 7

Freetown first, and outside Freetown

Freetown gets the full service. Other towns get the things that survive the journey.

GOODS	FREETOWN	BO, MAKENI, BONTHE AND OTHERS
Hot food, fresh fruit and vegetables, chilled and frozen	Delivered	Not available They would spoil on the way.
Dry goods, clothes, print, electronics, household	Delivered	Parcel Through a transport partner, to a pickup point or agent.

- Every product has a **"can ship outside Freetown"** flag. Only long-lasting goods can have it.
- **Parcel delivery:** longer delivery time (days, not minutes), a fee based on the town and carrier, and a handover at an agent point in that town.
- **Bonthe** depends on boat timing, so it gets a longer window.
- The customer sees which items can't go to their town before checkout, not after.

SECTION 8

The map: landmarks to 3D

Most Freetown addresses have no street name, so directions are given by landmarks. The map should work the same way first, then grow into street photos and 3D.

Phase 1 · first

Landmarks and pins

A real 2D map with landmarks, delivery pins dropped by customers, and rider routes. This is what actually makes deliveries arrive.

Phase 2

360° street photos

Main roads first. Cameras on e-kekes can collect photos over time. Faces and number plates are blurred. This is our own capture; Google's imagery can't be copied.

Phase 3

3D key areas

Downtown, Lumley and Aberdeen with drones and photogrammetry. Drones need permits, and 3D is heavy on data, so it needs a low-data option.

Then expand area by area, as the plan says: "more and more locations".

SECTION 9

Order of work

Money first, then reach, then the big differentiator.

STEP	WHAT	WHY THIS ORDER
1	Open marketplace, sellers, "by" tags, simple pages	This is where the money starts: commission on every sale, and it fills the app with products quickly.
2	Custom pages, service pages, quote requests	Keeps sellers loyal and brings in service providers.
3	Events calendar and tickets, with the DA HOOD Car Theater pilot	Cheap to build, brings new users every weekend, and tests door agents.
4	Parcels outside Freetown	Once a transport partner is signed.
5	Landmark map (phase 1)	Needed for deliveries, alongside steps 1–3.
6	Search by photo, 360° street photos, then 3D	Needs a big catalogue and funding. A strong reason to choose THE PLUG once live.

SECTION 10

Decisions still open

The prototype uses the suggested values, all changeable in its admin settings.

DECISION	SUGGESTED START	NOTES
Marketplace commission	Not set	Compare with what sellers pay elsewhere. Keep it low at launch.
Products needed for a custom page	5	Adjust after seeing real sellers.
Ticket fee and who pays it	5%, paid by the buyer (sample)	Show the full price upfront either way.
Seller and organizer checks	Phone for all, ID plus papers for businesses	Who on the team does the checks.
Payment provider	Mobile money first	Needed for tickets and online payments.
Agent pay	Per event	Written agreement, including for DA HOOD members.
Transport partner for parcels	Not chosen	Needed before shipping outside Freetown.
Map capture budget	Phase 1 only for now	Phases 2 and 3 when funded.

SECTION 11

What the updated prototype shows

The new website and app include everything above that can work with sample data in a browser.

PAGE OR SCREEN	WHAT YOU CAN DO	STATUS
Shop (open marketplace)	Search products, see how many sellers have each, compare price, stock and distance, add from different sellers.	Works (sample)
Business pages	Tap a "by" tag to open the seller's page: simple, custom or service style, with website link.	Works (sample)
Sell on THE PLUG	Set up a shop, choose your tag, upload a photo with background removal, add products and stock, watch your custom page unlock at 5 products.	Works simple removal
Quote requests	Post a request, see provider replies, choose one, and answer requests as a provider.	Works (simulated replies)
Search by photo	Upload a photo and pick what it looks like.	Matching not connected
Events calendar	Browse by day and type, THE PLUG picks, post an event, organizer review.	Works (sample)
Tickets and door agents	Buy tickets with demo payment, see your codes, scan or type codes at the door, offline list, cash sales, refunds on cancellation.	Works no real QR or camera
Delivery outside Freetown	Choose Bo, Makeni or Bonthe; fresh items are blocked; parcel fee and pickup point shown.	Works (sample fees)
Landmark map	Schematic Freetown map, drop your pin, landmarks, map roadmap.	Schematic, not a real map
DA HOOD partnership	Proposed partnership page, Car Theater pilot event, DA HOOD Clothing sample store.	Proposed, not signed